For the Japanese too, until almost the very end of the 20th century, Asia stopped at Myanmar. In August 2007, however, Prime Minister Shinzo Abe spoke of the confluence of the two oceans, the Pacific and the Indian, in a speech to the Indian Parliament, giving wider currency to the (then) novel coinage of the term the Indo-Pacific.[7] Now, as Japan is reimagining its role in the world, its officials speak of the objective of a "free and open" Indo-Pacific.[8] Interestingly, when Prime Minister Abe spoke in the Indian Parliament about "the confluence of the two seas" and about a "broader Asia" breaking away geographical boundaries and beginning to take on a distinct form, he did not refer to the Indian landmass.[9]

The "US-India Joint Strategic Vision for the Asia-Pacific and Indian Ocean Region" signed during US President Barack Obama's visit to India in 2015 did not use the term "the Indo-Pacific,"[10] although it was by then already widely used in Australian and American writings. Conventional wisdom among senior personnel in the Indian Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) at the time was that the term "Indo-Pacific" was of un-Indian origin and combined the nation (India) with the ocean (Pacific). Subsequently, however, the term "Indo-Pacific" acquired greater acceptance in Indian official circles. Thus, for instance, the joint statement issued when Modi met Trump in June 2017 referred to the two countries as "democratic stalwarts" and "responsible stewards" in the Indo-Pacific region and asserted that one of their common objectives is the promotion of "stability across the Indo-Pacific region."[11]

Australians have widely used the term "Indo-Pacific" to include the region covering the Asia-Pacific and the Indian Ocean, particularly since they published their *Defence White Paper* in 2013. An Australian commentator illustrates the relevance and importance of introducing the term "Indo-Pacific" by contending that India "is arguably not an Asia-Pacific country, a fact reflected by its continued exclusion